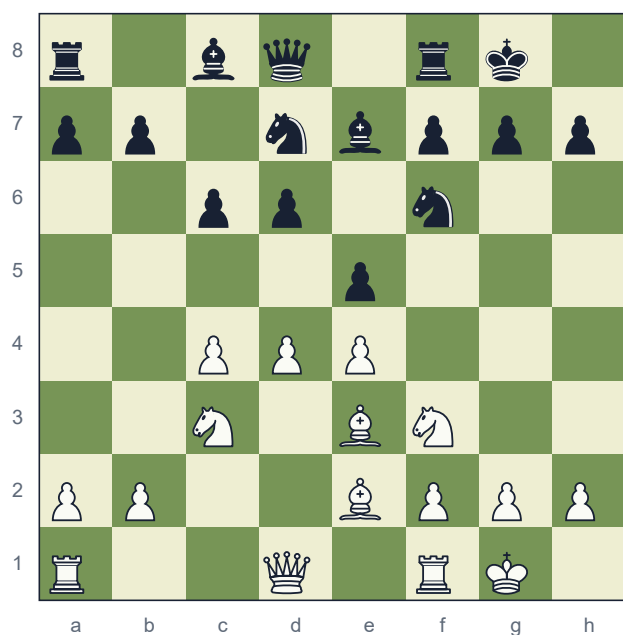


Old Indian and Modern move orders

...d6, ...g6 and early ...Bg4

YOUR REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Keep 2.c4 against ...d6 or ...g6 when you want to remain in this repertoire. Take central space, develop naturally, and identify whether Black finally chooses ...e5 or ...d5.



Main-line anchor - Black to move

THE PAWN STRUCTURE

Black can postpone the knight development and choose among Indian structures. White should avoid committing to an inflexible setup too early.

WHAT BLACK WANTS

The Old Indian uses ...d6, ...Nf6 and ...e5 without a king-bishop fianchetto. The Modern may delay ...Nf6 and challenge the center in several ways.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. 2.c4 is sound against 1...d6 and 1...g6; these are not mandatory exceptions.
2. After a delayed ...d5, revisit the Grunfeld or QGD central tension rather than pushing e4 automatically.
3. If the c8 bishop reaches g4, account for exchanges on f3 before choosing your pawn structure.

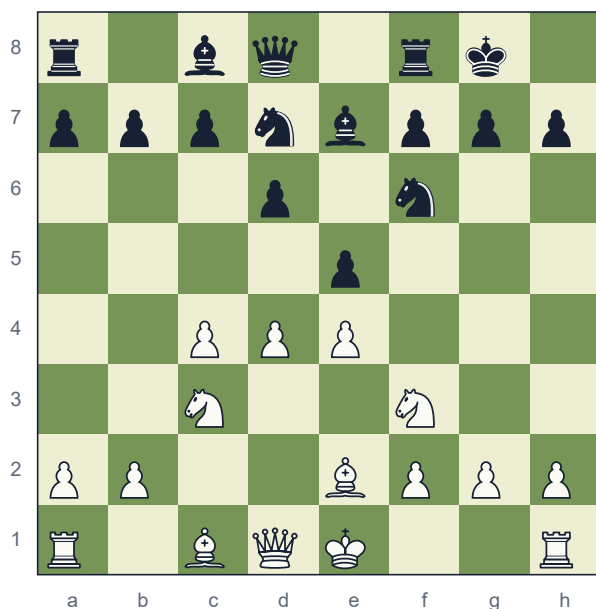
Line pages contain a selected opening anchor plus an illustrative checked continuation. They are not a forced script. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Old Indian classical center

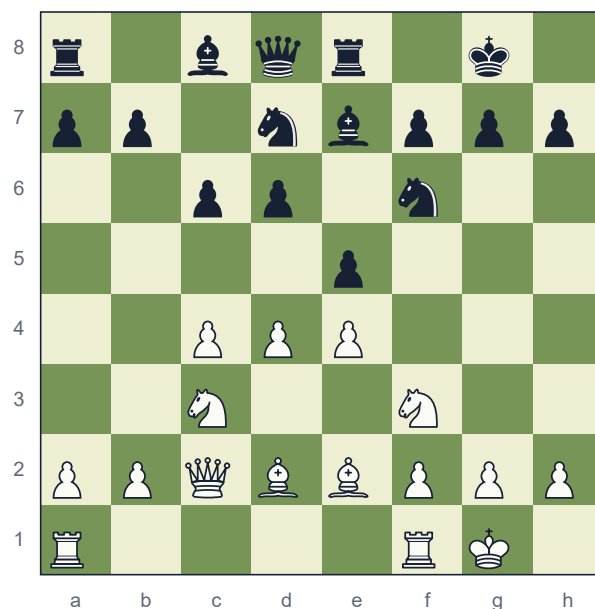
STUDY LINE 20-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Nf3 Nbd7 5. e4 Be7 6. Be2 O-O 7. O-O c6 8. Be3 Ng4 9. Bd2 Ngf6 10. Qc2 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 8. Be3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 6 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The broad center is supported by development. Black is compact and will seek a freeing pawn break.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use Qc2 and central rooks, or close with d5 if the timing is favorable. Watch ...exd4 and ...Re8 before pushing e5.

WATCH FOR

A space advantage can become overextension if your pieces cannot defend the advanced pawns.

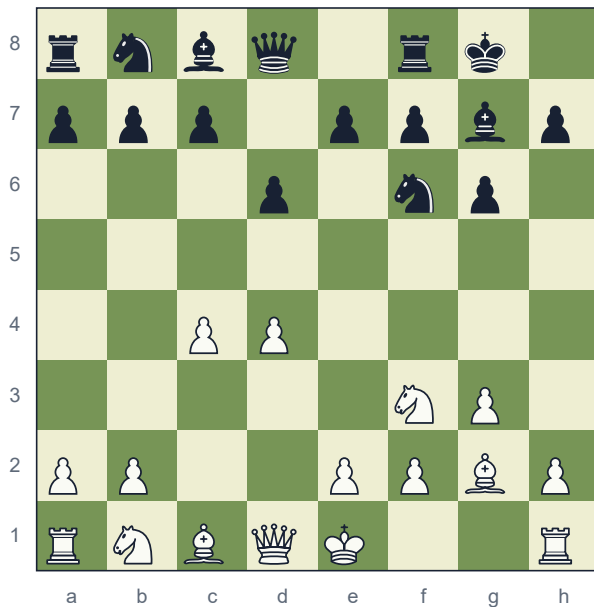
REMEMBER Occupy the center and keep it supported.

02 Modern: keep the c4 center

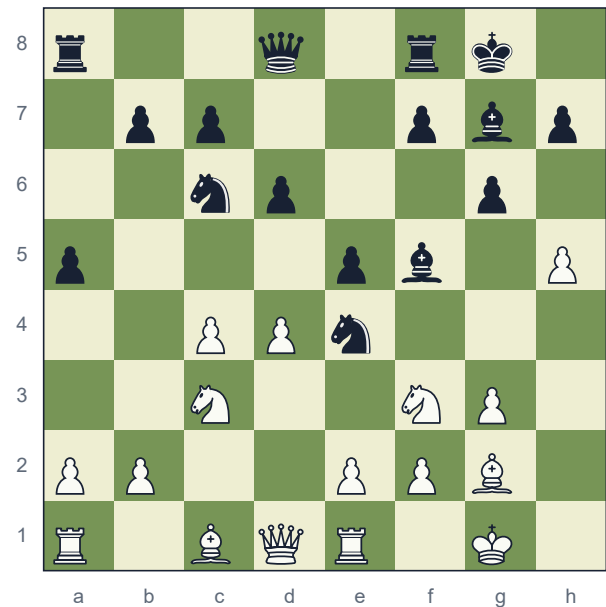
STUDY LINE 20-02

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nf3 d6 4. g3 Nf6 5. Bg2 O-O 6. O-O Bf5 7. Re1 a5 8. Nc3 Ne4 9. h4 Nc6 10. h5 e5

Selected anchor ends with 6. O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 5 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The delayed knight move transposes to the fianchetto King's Indian. You have avoided introducing an unrelated e4-opening repertoire.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Nc3 and e4 are familiar goals. If Black instead chooses ...c5 or ...d5, consult the relevant central structure.

WATCH FOR

Do not assign an opening name before Black has committed the central pawns.

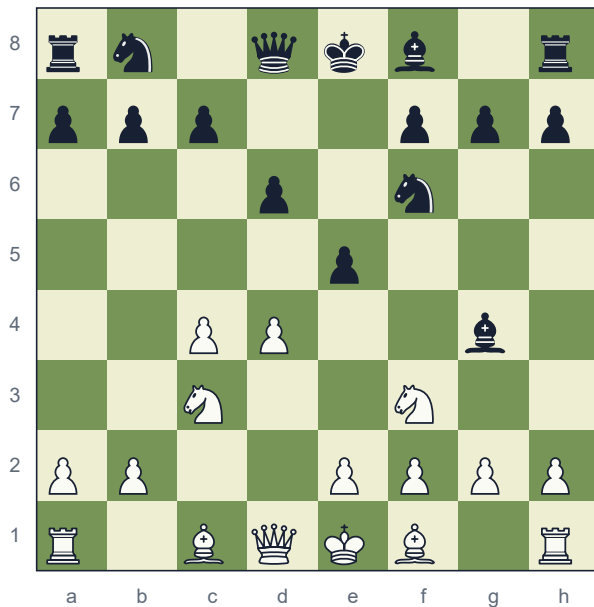
REMEMBER Wait for the central commitment before choosing the plan.

03 ...d6 and ...Bg4

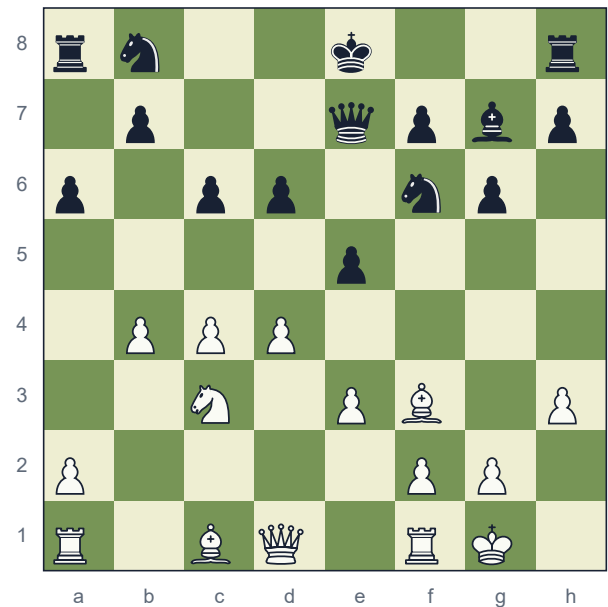
STUDY LINE 20-03

1. d4 d6 2. c4 Nf6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Nf3 Bg4 5. e3 Qe7 6. Be2 g6 7. h3 Bxf3 8. Bxf3 c6 9. O-O Bg7 10. b4 a6

Selected anchor ends with 5. e3. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 4 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

e3 maintains a flexible center and opens the f1 bishop. The pin deserves attention, but it does not require an immediate pawn chase.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop Be2 or Bd3 and castle. Challenge the center or bishop only after counting tactical captures.

WATCH FOR

If ...Bxf3 doubles your pawns, assess king safety before accepting the structural damage.

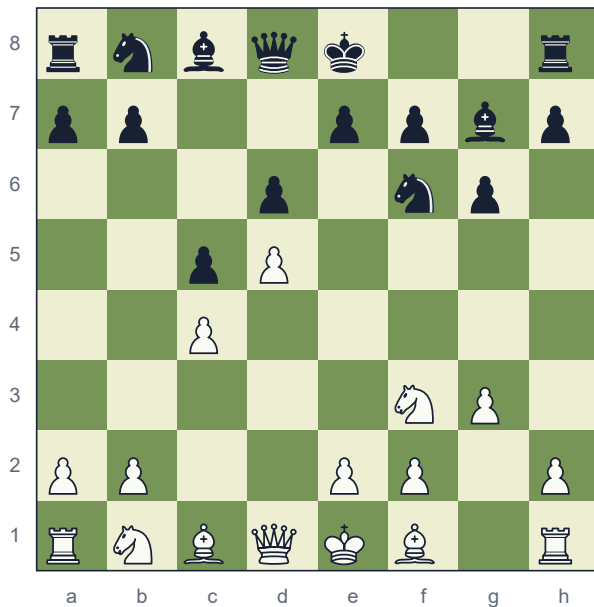
REMEMBER Develop through the pin and preserve options.

04 Modern with ...c5 before ...Nf6

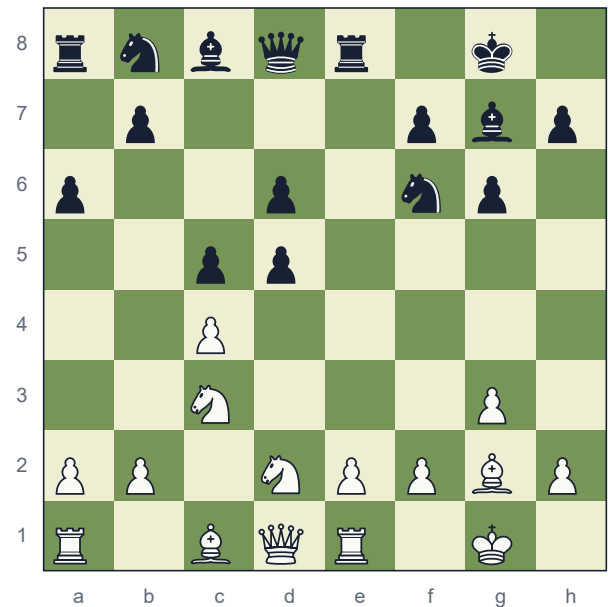
STUDY LINE 20-04

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nf3 c5 4. d5 d6 5. g3 Nf6 6. Bg2 O-O 7. O-O Re8 8. Re1 a6 9. Nc3 e6 10. Nd2 exd5

Selected anchor ends with 6... O-O. Later moves illustrate one checked continuation.



Checkpoint after move 5 - White to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

d5 gains space and leads to a Benoni-like structure without requiring the standard ...e6 exchange immediately.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

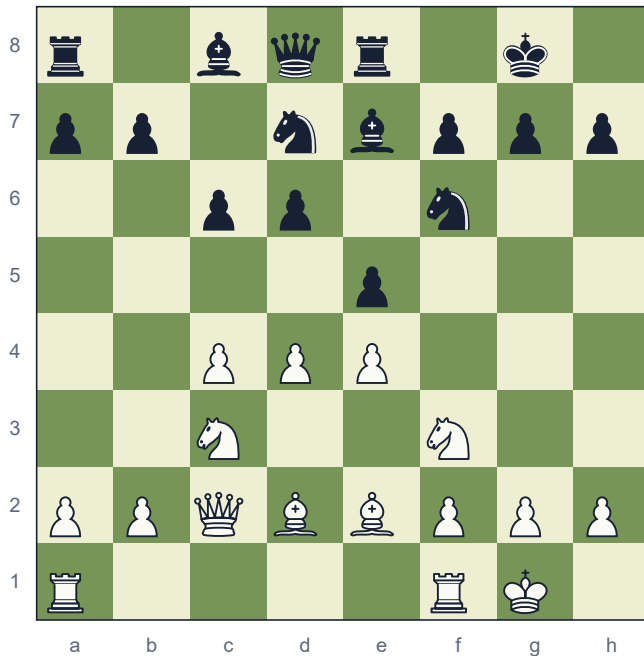
Castle, develop Nc3 and consider e4. Black's ...e6 and ...b5 breaks must be monitored.

WATCH FOR

Without an exchange on d5, the pawn structure differs from the Modern Benoni main line. Reassess before using a memorized plan.

REMEMBER Similar piece placement does not guarantee the same structure.

Review before your next game



Main-line study position - White to move

1. IDENTIFY THE STRUCTURE.

Black can postpone the knight development and choose among Indian structures. White should avoid committing to an inflexible setup too early.

2. NAME BLACK'S PLAN.

The Old Indian uses ...d6, ...Nf6 and ...e5 without a king-bishop fianchetto. The Modern may delay ...Nf6 and challenge the center in several ways.

3. CHOOSE YOUR NEXT JOB.

Use Qc2 and central rooks, or close with d5 if the timing is favorable. Watch ...exd4 and ...Re8 before pushing e5.

RECONSTRUCTION DRILL

Set up the starting position and play the main study line without looking. After each Black move, say what changed. If you cannot explain your reply, stop at that position and review the relevant line page.

DECISION DRILL

Return to the diagram. Write two candidate moves and a likely reply to each. You are not trying to guess the next engine move: you are testing whether your choices fit the structure and survive checks, captures and threats.

SELF-CHECK

Can you identify every capture and recapture in the line? Can you state one move-order exception? Can you explain the final position without using the opening name?

Related practice: Booklet 24. Use the matching line ID in the PGN companion. Opening names: Lichess public opening dataset; original course choices and analysis, checked with Stockfish 18.